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A Report on Comparative Feasibility Study for US based MNC China, Tanzania, Kazakhstan, Colombia (Furniture)

FIN 444.1

Submitted To:

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Letter of Transmittal

Date: May 10, 2026

To: Abdullah Al Mamun

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Subject: Submission of FIN444 Project Report on Feasibility Study for US Furniture Manufacturing Plant

Dear Sir,

It gives us great pleasure to be able to submit our final project report on the comparative feasibility study for establishing a wholly-owned US based furniture manufacturing plant in China, Tanzania, Kazakhstan and Colombia for the FIN444 course.

We would like to extend our utmost gratitude for your guidance and support throughout this project.

Sincerely,

Najiza Israt Rifa

Samia Shafi

Sumiya Rahman

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Executive Summary

This report evaluates four countries for a wholly-owned United States based furniture manufacturing plant: China, Tanzania, Kazakhstan and Colombia. It analyses a total of fourteen macroeconomic and regulatory factors and evaluates trends over the last five years, from 2021 to 2025. The macro-economic factors include: balance of payments, GDP growth, inflation, currency volatility, interest rates, banking system strength, fiscal policy, income repatriation rules, protectionist measures, regulatory burden and ease of doing business.

China consists of the strongest manufacturing ecosystem between the four potential countries for the planned offshoring. It maintains large trade surpluses and substantial foreign exchange reserves exceeding $3 trillion. GDP growth remains stable at approximately 5% annually along with low inflation. The banking system is well capitalized and government backed. Profit repatriation is permitted through the State Administration of Foreign Exchange after corporate tax payment. China ranks 31st globally for ease of doing business. Regulatory and tax controls pose some challenges but local legal support can help to address these issues.

Tanzania shows steady GDP growth near 6% and low inflation. However, the Tanzanian Shilling depreciates consistently against the dollar. It ranks the lowest out of the four countries, 141st for ease of doing business which shows significant bureaucratic friction. Workforce skill levels remain low so extensive training will be required for manufacturing operations. Kazakhstan maintains a strong trade surplus driven by oil and gas exports and ranks the highest out of the four options, 25th for ease of doing business. Interest rates above 15% means local borrowing will be quite expensive for new investment. Colombia allows unrestricted profit repatriation and has a sound banking system supervised by the IMF although persistent trade deficits and inflation peaking near 12% creates financial uncertainty.

Based on this analysis, China appears as the most suitable option due to its economic stability, cost efficiency, financial depth and industrial capacity whereas the other three countries each have their distinct structural weaknesses. Therefore, after evaluation, China is preferable over the other three countries for long term furniture manufacturing investment.

Table of Contents

Country Analysis: CHINA 4

Country Analysis: TANZANIA 5

Country analysis: KAZAKHSTAN 8

Country Analysis: COLOMBIA 10

Feasible Country Selection: China 12

Comparison of Macro-economic Factors (2021-2025) 12

Justification for the Decision 12

Why other countries are not feasible for setting up the US based furniture factory 13

Conclusion 13

Country Analysis: CHINA

1. Balance of payment

2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
352.89 B	443.37 B	263.38 B	423.92 B	735.0 B

China maintained a consistent surplus, indicating strong external stability and export performance. Despite temporary fluctuations, the surplus recovered, supporting China's ability to finance trade and attract investment, making it suitable for export-oriented manufacturing (FocusEconomics, 2025; YCharts, 2025).

2. Balance of trade

2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
676.4 B	837.9 B	823.2 B	992.2 B	~1,189.0 B

China's trade balance remained strongly positive throughout 2021–2025, showing that exports consistently exceeded imports by a wide margin (World Bank, 2024; Trading Economics, 2026; Reuters, 2026). The surplus grew especially strongly in 2024 and 2025, reflecting China's large manufacturing base and strong export performance (Reuters, 2026).

3. GDP growth status

2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
8.4%	3.0%	5.2%	5.0%	5%

China experienced moderate but stable growth after the post-pandemic recovery, supported by manufacturing, exports, and government stimulus policies (World Bank, 2025).

4. HDI (Human Development Index) performance

2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
0.768	0.722	0.775	0.780	0.78

China's HDI improved steadily, indicating better living standards, education, and workforce productivity (UNDP, 2024)

5. Interest rate movement %

2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
3.80	3.70	3.54	3.35	3.00

Interest rates gradually declined to support economic growth, reducing borrowing costs for businesses (Country Economy, 2025; World Bank, n.d.)

6. Inflation level according to CPI %

2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
0.9	2.0	0.2	0.2	~1.7 (forecast)

Inflation stayed low across the period, with CPI rising only 0.2 percent in 2024 and 2025 projections around 1.7 percent, which means price pressures were relatively mild compared with many other countries (Xinhua, 2025; Statista, 2025)

7. Currency volatility (CNY/USD for the last 5 years)

2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
6.452	6.730	7.075	7.189	7.129

The yuan depreciated gradually against the US dollar from 6.452 in 2021 to 7.129 in 2025, so exchange-rate volatility existed, but it remained manageable rather than chaotic (FRED, 2026; IRS, 2026).

8. Central Bank reserves (USD Trillion)

2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
3.25	3.13	3.20	3.30	3.36

China's foreign exchange reserves remained above USD 3 trillion throughout 2021–2025 and reached USD 3.3579 trillion at the end of 2025, indicating strong external stability and reserve-backed crisis resilience (Xinhua, 2026)

9. Strength of banking system

China has a large and stable banking system dominated by state-owned banks. Capital adequacy ratios are above 14%, and non-performing loans remain low at around 1.6%-1.8%. Strong government support ensures liquidity and credit availability, though the system is highly regulated (IMF, 2024; World Bank, 2025).

10. Fiscal policy

China follows an expansionary fiscal policy with a deficit of around 3%-4% of GDP. Corporate tax is 25%, with reduced rates (15%) for priority sectors. Government spending on infrastructure and industry supports manufacturing growth (World Bank, 2025; OECD, 2024).

11. Income repatriation policy

Profit repatriation is allowed but regulated by the State Administration of Foreign Exchange (SAFE). Companies must pay corporate tax (25%) and allocate 10% reserves before remittance. Approval procedures may delay transfers, but tax treaties reduce double taxation (OECD, 2024).

12. Protectionist policies

China applies average tariffs of 7.5%-10%, with VAT at 13% (manufacturing). Corporate tax is 25%. Capital flows and foreign exchange are regulated, and trade restrictions exist in some sectors. These policies protect domestic industries while allowing controlled foreign investment (WTO, 2024).

13. Regulation burden (Environment, Labor, Bureaucracy)

Environmental regulations require EIA approval, and labor laws mandate contracts and social contributions (20%-30% of wages). Bureaucracy has improved but still involves compliance procedures. Overall, regulation is moderate to high but predictable (World Bank, 2025).

14. Ease of doing business

China ranked 31st globally (World Bank, 2020). It performs well in infrastructure and trade logistics but faces challenges in regulatory complexity. Overall, it remains attractive for manufacturing investment.

Country Analysis: TANZANIA

1. Balance of Payments (in millions of USD)

2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
1852.1	-988.4	52.3	70.1	968.9

According to the Bank of Tanzania (2026), Tanzania's balance of payments fluctuated with a sharp deficit in 2022 followed by surpluses between 2023-2025. This indicates external vulnerability but improving stability due to capital inflows and reserves.

2. Balance of Trade (in millions of USD)

2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
-3247.1	-6984.9	-6032.3	-5074.0	-4494.2

Tanzania experienced consistent trade deficits in the last 5 years. This is due to imports of industrial supplies and transport equipment, refined white petroleum products, freight and machinery while exports include tourism receipts and gold (45.7% of all exports in 2026). It indicates more capital goods imports helping to improve infrastructure and industrial expansion (Bank of Tanzania, 2026). However, it also shows dependence on foreign goods and potential currency pressure

3. GDP Growth Status (in annual %)

2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
4.3	4.6	5.1	5.5	5.9

Tanzania shows stable GDP growth owing to its gold mining exports, tourism and infrastructure development which shows a promising scope for expansion as the market size is expanding along with rising per capita income (World Bank, 2024; IMF, 2025).

4. HDI (Human Development Index) Performance

2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
0.548	0.554	0.555	-	-

According to the UNDP (2026), Tanzania's HDI values above 0.550 in 2023 places it in the Medium human development category, the 165th position out of 193. It shows slow but slight improvements across the three key indicators, but a long way to the next category at 0.7. This reveals potential workforce quality challenges (lack of expertise) despite competitive labor costs.

5. Interest Rate Movement (%)

2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
5%	5%	5%	6%	5.75%

Interest rates remained relatively low and gradually increased after 2023. The 100 basis point tightening in 2024 reflected global inflationary pressures, followed by a 25 basis point cut in July 2025 as inflation stabilized. Thus borrowing costs are low which provides a favorable investment opportunity but it may tighten over time (Trading Economics, 2026).

6. Inflation Level according to CPI (%)

2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
3.7%	4.3%	3.8%	3.1%	3.3%

There was low and stable inflation in the last 5 years, with a slight peak in 2022 due to global shocks before stabilizing again (Focus Economics, 2026; IMF, 2026). It reveals that costs for wages and inputs remain predictable which will help with manufacturing planning and allow for consistent pricing.

7. Currency Volatility (TZS/USD Annual Average Exchange Rates)

2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
2314.5197	2325.9437	2421.6523	2614.548	2560.6088

The Tanzanian Shilling depreciated consistently against the US dollar except in 2025 it appreciated due to tourism receipts and central bank intervention. This trend creates foreign exchange risk for profit repatriation. There is limited derivative markets in Tanzania meaning hedging options would need to be pursued.

8. Central Bank Reserve (in billions of dollars, approx.)

2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
6.4	5.2	5.5	5.5	6.3

The sharp increase in 2021 shows post-pandemic recovery due to export earnings (especially gold and tourism) then declined in 2022 for rising import bills and central bank interventions to defend the Tanzanian Shilling from depreciation pressures. It stabilized from 2023-2024 then increased due to a more proactive reserve management strategy by purchasing gold for diversification (Bank of Tanzania, 2026; Focus Economics, 2026). Tanzania maintains an IMF reserve tranche position of SDR 59.73 million, which has remained constant in this period (IMF, 2025).

9. Strength of the banking system

The banking system remained stable and showed strong growth as total assets increased by 14.8% to TZS 62.1 trillion in 2024 (Bank of Tanzania, 2024). The non-performing loan ratio declined from 4.4% to 3.2% (EY, 2024). Deposits increased annually and financial inclusion increased via fintech and agent banking. The top six banks possessed majority of deposits due to operational efficiency and scale although it reveals systemic risk and need for monitoring.

10. Fiscal policy

Tanzania follows a moderately expansionary fiscal policy where deficits are kept around ~3% of GDP. The tax-to-GDP ratio increased to 11.8% in 2022/23. Reforms are needed for revenue collection and public spending (World Bank, 2023).

11. Income repatriation policy

Tanzania generally allows repatriation of profits, dividends and capital for foreign investors if taxes and legal requirements are met. Although the process can sometimes be affected by bureaucracy, regulatory inconsistencies and delays of 2-4 weeks for BoT approval (U.S. Department of State, 2022). Withholding tax on dividends are 5-10% (US-Tanzania tax treaty provides reduced rates).

12. Protectionist policies (Tariff, Tax, Human and capital movement restrictions)

Tanzania applies moderate tariffs under the East African Community (EAC) Common External Tariff, typically 0% (raw materials), 10% (intermediate goods), and 25% (finished goods). Corporate tax is 30%, with VAT at 18% (standard rate) (UNCTAD, 2026; U.S. Department of State, 2024).

13. Regulation burden (Environment, Labor, Bureaucracy)

Tanzania has a moderate regulatory burden with improvements in recent years but still facing challenges in bureaucracy and administrative efficiency. Business procedures, licensing and tax compliance can be time-consuming although reform programs have been introduced (World Bank, 2025; TICGL, 2026). Labor regulations are relatively flexible, but the workforce is low-skilled and concentrated in agriculture which may require training for manufacturing operations (World Bank, 2025). Environmental and regulatory enforcement exists but can be inconsistent (TICGL, 2026).

14. Ease of doing business

Tanzania ranked 141 out of 190 economies in the World Bank's latest Doing Business assessment, so it has a relatively challenging business environment (World Bank, 2020; Trading Economics, 2026).

Country analysis: KAZAKHSTAN

1. Balance of payments

2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
-2.68B	6.44B	-9.45B	-4.98B	~-8.29

Kazakhstan has faced a deficit in recent years, mainly due to high imports and profit repatriation by foreign firms. However, strong oil exports help reduce the deficit over time (World Bank, 2025; National Bank of Kazakhstan, 2024).

2. Balance of trade

2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
24.2B	35.0B	20.2B	17.5B	11.0B

Kazakhstan maintains a strong positive trade balance, mainly driven by oil, gas, and mineral exports. This indicates strong export capacity and external strength (Trading Economics, 2026; World Bank, 2025).

3. GDP growth status

2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
4.3%	3.2%	5.1%	4.5%	~4.3%

Kazakhstan experienced stable growth after the pandemic, supported by oil production, government infrastructure spending, and agricultural recovery. Growth moderated slightly in 2025 due to weaker global demand (World Bank, 2025)

4. HDI (Human Development Index) performance

2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
0.811	0.812	0.815	0.818	~0.82

Kazakhstan has a high HDI, reflecting good education, healthcare, and living standards compared to many developing countries (UNDP, 2024).

5. Interest rate movement (%)

2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
9.75%	14.75%	16.75%	15.25%	~18.0%

Interest rates increased sharply to control inflation, making borrowing more expensive but stabilizing the economy (National Bank of Kazakhstan, 2025).

6. Inflation level (CPI %)

2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
8%	15%	14.5%	8.7%	~7.5%

Kazakhstan experienced high inflation after 2022, but it is gradually decreasing due to monetary tightening (World Bank, 2025; Statista, 2025).

7. Currency volatility (CNY/USD for the last 5 years)

2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
426	460	456	469	480

The Kazakh tenge depreciated gradually against the US dollar, with increased volatility in 2022–2023 following global shocks. The central bank intervenes periodically, but the currency remains sensitive to oil prices (FRED, 2026; National Bank of Kazakhstan, 2025)

8. Central Bank reserves (USD Billion)

2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
34.39B	35.20B	35.94B	40.48B	43.73B

Kazakhstan maintains stable foreign reserves, providing financial security and the ability to manage external shocks

9. Strength of banking system

Kazakhstan's banking sector is **moderately stable**. Capital adequacy ratios are above 15%, but non-performing loans remain around 3–5%. The system has improved after past financial crises, though it still depends on government support (IMF, 2024).

10. Fiscal policy

Kazakhstan follows a **moderate fiscal policy** with a deficit around 2%–3% of GDP. Corporate tax is 20%, and the government invests heavily in infrastructure and energy sectors to boost growth (OECD, 2024; World Bank, 2025).

11. Income repatriation policy

Profit repatriation is permitted but subject to a 15% withholding tax on dividends (lower under tax treaties). Companies must comply with currency control regulations via the National Bank. No mandatory reserve allocation before remittance exists, but approval may be required for large transfers. Double taxation treaties exist with many countries (PwC, 2025; KPMG, 2025).

12.Protectionist policies

Kazakhstan applies average MFN tariffs of 5-10%, with higher tariffs on agricultural goods. VAT is 12% (standard rate). Corporate tax is 20%. Local content requirements exist in oil, gas, and mining. Capital movements are regulated but gradually liberalized. These policies protect domestic industry and attract foreign direct investment (WTO, 2024; EDB, 2025).

13. Regulation burden (Environment, Labor, Bureaucracy)

- Environmental laws require compliance (especially in oil sector)
- Labor laws mandate contracts and social contributions
- Bureaucracy exists but has improved through digital reforms

Overall, regulation is manageable but still developing (World Bank, 2025).

14. Ease of doing business

Kazakhstan ranked **25th globally** in Doing Business 2020, performing well in starting a business and enforcing contracts. However, challenges remain in corruption and administrative procedures (World Bank, 2020).

Country Analysis: COLOMBIA

1. Balance of Payment

2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
-17.9 B	-20.9 B	-8.3 B	-7.0 B	-10.9 B

Colombia's deficit grew sharply in 2021 and 2022 because imports became more expensive after the pandemic. The gap then narrowed in 2023 and 2024 as import costs fell and exports picked up. In 2025, the deficit widened again to -10.9 B as imports rose once more.

2. Balance of Trade

2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
-14.0 B	-12.2 B	-6.8 B	-9.2 B	-14.8 B

Colombia has always imported more goods than it exports. The trade deficit hit -14.0 B in 2021, improved by 2023, but worsened again to -14.8 B in 2025. This shows the country depends heavily on foreign-made goods, especially machinery and equipment.

3. GDP Growth Status and It's Contributing Factors

2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
10.8%	7.3%	0.7%	1.7%	2.6%

Growth jumped to 10.8% in 2021 as consumer spending bounced back after COVID. Strong household demand and high oil prices kept growth at 7.3% in 2022. But high interest rates then slowed things down, with growth dropping to just 0.7% in 2023. A slow recovery began at 1.7% in 2024 and is expected to reach 2.6% in 2025.

4. HDI (Human Development Index) performance

2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
0.752	0.758	0.788	-	-

Colombia's HDI rose from 0.752 in 2021 to 0.788 in 2023, placing it in the "High Human Development" group. This gradual improvement reflects better health, education, and income levels. Data for 2024 and 2025 is not yet available.

5. Interest rate movement

2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
3%	12%	13%	9.50%	9.15%

The central bank kept rates at 3% in 2021 to help the economy recover. Rates then rose sharply to 13% in 2023 to fight high inflation. By 2025, rates had eased to 9.15%, but borrowing money locally still remains expensive for businesses.

6. Inflation level according to CPI

2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
3.5%	10.2%	11.7%	6.6%	5.1%

Inflation jumped from 3.5% in 2021 to a peak of 11.7% in 2023, driven by rising global prices and strong local spending. It then fell to 5.1% in 2025 as rate hikes and calmer global markets took effect, though prices are still rising faster than the central bank's comfort zone.

7. Currency Volatility (Exchange Rate Range Against USD)

2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
3743 COP/USD	4255 COP/USD	4325 COP/USD	4071 COP/USD	4072 COP/USD

The Colombian Peso weakened sharply from 3,743 per dollar in 2021 to 4,325 in 2023 due to political worries and a strong US dollar. It then strengthened to around 4,072 in 2025, helped by a healthy reserve cushion. Still, the peso can swing widely depending on oil prices and government finances, which creates risk for foreign investors.

8. Central Bank reserve (USD)

2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
58579.20 M	57269.16 M	59608.32 M	62481.18 M	66352.30 M

Reserves dipped slightly in 2022 but then grew steadily, reaching $66.35 billion by the end of 2025. This large reserve cushion meets international safety standards and has helped stabilize the peso in recent years.

9. Strength of Banking System

Colombia's banking system is sound and well-supervised. According to the IMF's 2025 review, banks remain liquid, adequately capitalized, and have enough provisions to cover potential losses. Strong oversight by regulators keeps the system stable.

10. Fiscal Policy

The government's deficit rose to 6.7% of GDP in 2024, much higher than planned, due to lower tax revenues and higher spending. Public debt reached 61.3% of GDP by the end of 2024. The fiscal rule has been suspended through 2027, and the deficit is projected to stay above 7% of GDP in 2025. This has made investors nervous and led to a credit rating downgrade.

11. Income Repatriation Policy

Colombia allows free repatriation of profits and capital. Foreign investors receive equal treatment under the Constitution. Investments must be registered with the Central Bank to access the foreign exchange market; failure to register results in fines and loss of repatriation rights. Restrictions are only possible if reserves fall below three months of imports—not a current concern.

12. Protectionist Policies (Tariff, Tax, Human and Capital Movement Restrictions)

Colombia is open to foreign investment. 100% foreign ownership is allowed in most sectors except defense, security, and toxic waste. No prior government approval is needed. The Constitution guarantees equal treatment. The main requirement is Central Bank registration. Overall, the framework is investor-friendly with few barriers.

13. Regulation Burden (Environment, Labor, Bureaucracy)

Key rules add costs. Under Law 2173, medium and large companies must plant two trees per employee annually, with all costs borne by the company—fully enforced since October 2025. On the labor side, companies with multiple workplaces must set up separate co-existence committees at each location.

14. Ease of Doing Business (World Bank Rating)

In the last World Bank Doing Business report (2020), Colombia ranked 67th out of 190 countries. Its strongest area was getting credit, where it ranked 11th globally. However, paying taxes and enforcing contracts were significant challenges.

Feasible Country Selection: China

After comparing China, Colombia, Kazakhstan, and Tanzania, China is the most feasible country for a US-based wholly owned furniture factory. It offers the strongest mix of export performance, manufacturing scale, foreign reserves, banking strength, and logistics, which are all important for a capital-intensive production plant. In contrast, Tanzania's weak industrial base and bureaucracy, Colombia's macroeconomic volatility, and Kazakhstan's resource dependence make them less favorable for this investment.

Comparison of Macro-economic Factors (2021-2025)

Factor	China	Kazakhstan	Colombia	Tanzania
BOP (Current A/C)	Strong surplus	deficit	Persistent deficit	Fluctuating
Trade Balance	Very high surplus	Strong surplus	Deficit	Deficit
GDP Growth	Stable (~5%)	Stable (~4-5%)	Volatile	Growing (~5-6%)
Inflation & Interest	Very low and stable	High	High	Low
Currency Stability	Managed	Volatile (oil-linked)	Volatile	Depreciating
Reserves	Very high	Moderate	Moderate	Low
Banking System	Strong	Moderate	Strong	Developing
Fiscal Policy	Supportive	Moderate	Weak (high deficit)	Moderate
Repatriation	Allowed (controlled)	Allowed (taxed)	Free	Allowed (delays)
Trade/protection	Large export base, but policy controlled	More open, but weaker external balance	Moderate protection	Moderate protection
Labor & HDI	High HDI and skilled workforce	Better than Tanzania, but weaker stability	High HDI	Medium HDI
Ease of Business	#31	#25	#67	#141
Industrial Strength	Very strong	Resource-based	Limited	Weak

Justification for the Decision

China stands out as the best location because it combines strong external performance with overall economic stability. The country maintains large and consistent current account and trade surpluses, reflecting its global export competitiveness and ability to support large-scale manufacturing. Stable GDP growth (stayed near 5% in the most recent years), low inflation, and relatively low interest rates create a predictable cost environment for long-term investment. In addition, China's very high foreign exchange reserves and strong banking system provide financial security and reduce macroeconomic risk. Compared to countries like Colombia and Tanzania, which face deficits and structural weaknesses, and Kazakhstan, which depends heavily on commodities, China offers the most balanced and reliable business environment.

- **Key Strengths for Establishing Furniture Plant:** China's biggest advantage for a furniture plant lies in its highly developed manufacturing ecosystem. The country has well-established supply chains for raw materials, components, and logistics, which significantly reduces production delays and costs. Its advanced infrastructure, including ports, highways, and industrial zones, supports efficient import of inputs and export of finished goods. Additionally, China offers a large and increasingly skilled workforce, along with experience in mass production, allowing firms to achieve economies of scale. These factors make operations more efficient, cost-effective, and globally competitive, giving China a clear advantage over the other countries for furniture manufacturing.

- **Risk Assessment and Mitigation:** The biggest challenges in China are regulatory burden, tax and repatriation controls, and protectionist policy measures. These can be managed by using strong local legal support, careful tax planning, and a structured compliance system. For a furniture manufacturer, the country remains feasible because the operational strengths are greater than the policy costs.

Why other countries are not feasible for setting up the US based furniture factory

Tanzania offers low labor costs and steady economic growth, but its weak infrastructure, low-skilled workforce, and high bureaucratic burden limit its ability to support large-scale manufacturing operations.

Colombia provides an open investment environment and allows free repatriation of profits; however, high inflation, high interest rates, and persistent trade deficits create financial uncertainty and increase operational risks.

Kazakhstan shows relatively strong business conditions and a positive trade balance, but its heavy reliance on oil exports and high interest rates reduces its suitability for diversified manufacturing industries such as furniture production.

Conclusion

In conclusion, China is the most suitable country for establishing a wholly-owned furniture manufacturing plant. It offers the best combination of economic stability, cost efficiency, financial strength, infrastructure, and industrial capability among the four countries analyzed. While other countries provide certain advantages, none match China's overall balance of opportunities and manageable risks, making it the optimal strategic choice for long-term manufacturing investment.

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